

Magic You

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Figure 1: Promotional image of Magic You

ABSTRACT

"Magic You" is a virtual reality interactive narrative experience. It is a coming-of-age story about ADHD, with joys, anxieties, bitter memories, and growing pains, told in a hand-drawn, coloured-pencil aesthetic as a magical journey. The artwork hopes to present the experiences and imagination of ADHD patients to the audience in a poetic way and give the audience a better understanding of ADHD, a manifestation of neurodiversity.

Index Terms: Human-centered computing—Human computer interaction (HCI)—Interaction paradigms—Virtual reality; Applied computing—Arts and humanities—Media arts

1 PROJECT URL

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2 INTRODUCTION

The artwork's experience unfolds across six key scenarios, blending surreal representations with interactive storytelling. As players progress through each stage of growth, the complexity of interactions deepens, introducing more dynamic and engaging elements. Players are encouraged to explore these scenarios spontaneously, immersing themselves in the following six scenes: "The First Birthday" (featuring Zhuazhou, a traditional Chinese ritual), "Adolescence," "Adulthood," "Surreal Tower," and "Reconciliation."

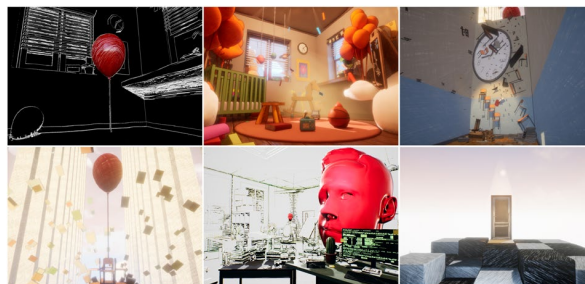


Figure 2: Scene Thumbnails

The interactions and artistic effects are inspired by two primary symptoms of ADHD: "Attention Deficit" and "Hyperactivity."

Grounded in research and interviews with ADHD individuals, each scene reflects specific symptoms associated with different life stages. For instance, the transformation of paper balls into paper planes draws from childhood memories shared by ADHD patients who fondly recalled playing with paper balls. Elements such as unreadable text and objects that cannot be grasped mirror common challenges faced by ADHD individuals. Additionally, flickering, colourful objects in each scene serve a dual purpose: they distract the player's attention while guiding them toward interactive elements.

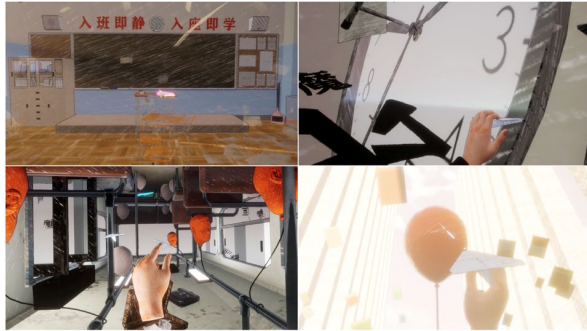


Figure 3: Multiple interactions present in the work

A key interaction, the “Paper Plane Launch,” allows players to use pinch and grip gestures to aim and shoot, enhancing their participation and immersion. Furthermore, we developed a climbing mechanic powered by hand-tracking. While VR climbing is typically controlled using handheld devices, this project leverages hand-tracking to enable climbing in a more natural and intuitive way. To optimize the experience, adjustments were made to the gripping coordinates, ensuring reliable performance and mitigating potential failures caused by the hand-tracking range.



Figure 4: Some special interactive effects in the work

The spatial narrative is designed with a largely vertical orientation, encouraging players to explore their environment through hand-tracking-based climbing. This vertical approach aligns with natural physical movements, potentially reducing motion sickness in VR. While many current VR experiences focus on horizontal exploration, this project offers a novel and experimental approach by presenting information in a vertical dimension.

Hand-tracking in this project goes beyond basic object manipulation. It integrates the act of launching paper planes with climbing and exploration, creating a immersive experience. Paper planes not only advance the narrative but also encourage players to venture beyond the main storyline, fostering a sense of curiosity and free exploration.



Figure 5: Poster

3 ARTIST INFORMATION

Tongze Guo is an XR director and Technical artist pursuing a Master's degree at the Department of Digital Media, Beijing Normal University, specializing in Virtual Reality creation, Immersive storytelling and Human-Computer Interaction (HCI). He completed his B.A degree in Digital Media Art at the Beijing Normal University. He is still learning and exploring the intersection between immersive art and interactive technology. His projects got “VR for Best Immersive Experiences Finalist” in the Short Video Section of the Shanghai International Film Festival and the “Audience Choice: Theatre Experience Award” in SIGGRAPH Asia. His work has been presented in Berlin, Tokyo, Beijing, Shanghai, and Hong Kong.